

Quick Start: From Install to Your First Trade

Getting Started | beginner | 30 min to complete | DeepCharts Help Center | August 24, 2026

By the end you will have DeepCharts installed, connected to market data, showing a chart with an indicator, and you will have placed your first simulated bracket order — entry, stop loss and take profit — without risking any money.

This is the capstone of the Getting Started series. Each step is short and links to a full article if you want more depth or hit a problem. You do not need a broker or a paid data feed to complete it — the free delayed feed and the built-in SIM broker are enough.

Before you start

- A Windows PC that meets the System Requirements
- A DeepCharts account at my.deepcharts.com with your license key — How to Install DeepCharts and Activate Your License shows where to find it
- No data feed credentials needed — this guide uses the free 15-minute delayed feed

Steps

1. Install and activate

1. Temporarily deactivate your antivirus — it is the most common cause of failed installs. Re-enable it after installation.
2. Download the installer from your my.deepcharts.com dashboard and run it. (If your license came through a **prop firm**, both the installer and the license key come from the prop firm's dashboard instead.)
3. On first launch, enter the **email** registered at my.deepcharts.com and your **license key**. Paste both without leading or trailing spaces — stray whitespace is the usual cause of "Invalid License".

Full detail: [How to Install DeepCharts and Activate Your License](#). Activation trouble: [Fix: License and Activation Issues](#)

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] The DeepCharts License Key dialog on first launch with the Email and License fields visible and the version number in the footer `dc-en-quick-start-first-trade-01.png`

2. Run the startup wizard

After activation a three-step wizard runs:

1. **Feed choice** — select **I want to use 15 minutes delayed data powered by dxFeed for the moment**. (If you already own feed credentials, pick the other option and see [How to Buy a Data Feed and Get Your Credentials](#) and [How to Connect a Data Feed \(Feed Settings\)](#).)
2. **Symbol Manage** — the wizard pre-maps the main exchanges (CME, CBOT, COMEX, EUREX, NYMEX) to your chosen feed. Leave the defaults and click **Next**.
3. **Customize experience** — pick a **Theme** and an **Alert sound profile**, then click **Done**.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] Startup wizard step 1 with the 15 minutes delayed data powered by dxFeed radio option selected `dc-en-quick-start-first-trade-02.png`

Note: Skipped or misclicked the wizard? Nothing is lost — Feed Settings, **Options** → **Symbol Manage** and **Options** → **Settings** cover the same ground later. See [Use the Free 15-Minute Delayed Data Feed](#).

3. Connect the feed

Open the feed selector at the top right of the main bar and click your connection. Wait for the **green dot** — that means data is flowing. Curious what a connection looks like under the hood? Explore the Feed Settings mock below — the source dropdown changes which fields each provider needs.

[WIDGET: feed-navigator]

4. Check Symbol Manage

Open **Options** → **Symbol Manage**. Each exchange row's **Data Feed** column should show your connection. If an exchange you want is missing, click **Subscribe** and add it. Try it in the mock below — subscribe an exchange and use the chain-link icon to change its feed. Details: Symbol Manage: Subscribe Exchanges and Map Your Feed.

[WIDGET: symbol-manage-mock]

5. Open your first chart

Click **New** → **Price Chart**, pick **CME** in the Select Instrument dialog, choose a symbol — **MES** (Micro S&P) or **MNQ** (Micro Nasdaq) are good beginner contracts — and click **Select**. Wait a few seconds while the chart builds. Full walkthrough: Open Your First Chart.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] The Select Instrument dialog with CME selected and MES MICRO SP highlighted
dc-en-quick-start-first-trade-03.png

6. Add your first indicator

1. Click the bar-graph icon in the chart's upper-left toolbar to open the Indicators panel.
2. Click the green **Indicators** button. The Indicator List opens with category tabs (All, Volume, Statistics, Oscillator, Overlay, Utility, Third) and a search box.
3. Search for **Volume** and click the **+** icon next to it. The indicator appears under the chart.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] The Indicator List window with the search box showing Volume and the + icon next to the Volume indicator highlighted
dc-en-quick-start-first-trade-04.png

How indicators are arranged and configured: How to Change the Layout of Indicators and Volume.

7. Turn on the trading panel with a SIM account

1. Enable the **Trading panel** toggle in the chart's bottom bar. The panel opens on the right side of the chart.
2. Set **Broker** to **SIM** and pick a simulation account in **Account**. If none exists, create one in **Options** → **Settings** → **Sim Account** — see Trading Accounts and Simulation.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] The chart trading panel with Broker set to SIM, an account selected, and quantity set to 1
dc-en-quick-start-first-trade-05.png

8. Place your first bracket order

1. Set the quantity field to **1**.
2. Enable the **OCO Strategy** toggle and set **Mode** to **SL/TP**.
3. Enter the **SL** (stop loss) and **TP** (take profit) distances in ticks — start wide while you are learning.
4. Click **BUY MKT**. Your entry fills on the SIM account and the stop-loss and take-profit orders are attached as a bracket — when one fills, the other is cancelled.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] The trading panel with OCO Strategy enabled, Mode set to SL/TP, SL and TP tick values entered, and the BUY MKT button highlighted
dc-en-quick-start-first-trade-06.png

Note: On the free delayed feed your fills are based on prices 15 minutes behind the live market — fine for learning the platform, not for judging a strategy. See OCO (One-Cancels-the-Other) Strategies for what every bracket setting does, and Trading from the Chart for placing orders directly on the chart.

To close everything at once, click **Cancel and Flat** — it flattens the position and cancels the remaining bracket orders.

Verify it worked

After clicking **BUY MKT**: **Open Qty** shows 1, **Open P/L** ticks with the market, and your stop and target are visible as working orders in the Orders Window. After **Cancel and Flat**, Open Qty returns to 0 and no working orders remain.

You have now touched every core part of the platform: install, data, charts, indicators and orders.

If something went wrong

Symptom	What to do
Installer will not run or fails	Fix: Installation Problems and Basic Requirements
"Invalid License" at activation	Fix: License and Activation Issues
Select Instrument list is empty	Symbol Manage: Subscribe Exchanges and Map Your Feed
Chart open but price not moving	Fix: Live Feed Connected but Chart Is Not Moving
Everything works but data seems old	Expected on the delayed feed — Use the Free 15-Minute Delayed Data Feed; for live data see How to Buy a Data Feed and Get Your Credentials

Related articles

- [Welcome to DeepCharts: Platform Tour](#)
- [How to Install DeepCharts and Activate Your License](#)
- [Use the Free 15-Minute Delayed Data Feed](#)
- [Trading Accounts and Simulation](#)
- [Trading from the Chart](#)
- [OCO \(One-Cancels-the-Other\) Strategies](#)